

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Working at Heights	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2026 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
General Safety	Fall from height	1	1. The person undertaking the work at heights will be suitably trained and competent in RIIWHS204D <i>Work Safely at Heights</i> 2. The person working at heights will wear the appropriate clothing and footwear to prevent heat stress and slipping. 3. The observer will be on site at all times while work is being carried out. 4. No person will work on a ladder unless restrained by a pole strap or have 3 limbs on the ladder at all times. 5. Ladders are to be at an angle of 70 – 80 degrees, extend 1m beyond the access point and be secured top and bottom. 6. If scaffolding is to be used it must be installed by a competent person in accordance with the scaffolding plan. 7. Before work starts each day a competent person will check the work activity for the day -Weather conditions / proximity to other services. 8. All workers to be advised of any changes to the worksite before work commences. 9. Do not leave tools unsecured on the height surface/access points or roof	Supervisor All Workers	2
Pre- working at heights survey	Fall from height	1	1. When conducting height surface pre-work walks/surveys the company representative shall note anchorage points for crews to use. 2. If no anchorage points or too few anchorages exist, the representative should inquire with the customer, client, owner, or general contractor about the possibility of adding anchor points. 3. In addition to anchorage points, height surface or roof access points shall be discussed with the following; the customer, client, owner, or general contractor.	Supervisor All Workers	2
Fall prevention V's fall-arrest	Fall from height	1	Training is to be undertaken to allow the understanding of the difference between fall prevention and fall arrest and how to implement each system when it is relevant	Manager and site supervisor	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Fall-Arrest Harness System	Fall from height	1	1. The fall arrest system must comply with the relevant standard. 2. Each anchor must be engineering designed. 3. Each anchor point must be inspected and approved by a competent person. 4. Each anchor point must be located so that a lanyard can be attached before the person moves into a position that they may fall. 5. Access to the fixing point will be by a ladder which will be fixed to prevent slipping. 6. There must be enough distance available to prevent the person hitting the ground if the person fell. 7. No person is allowed to use the system alone. 8. Consider emergency procedures should there be a fall to retrieve the fallen person The person using the system must be trained in its operation	Supervisor All Workers	2
Work on a Truck>2m in height	Fall from height	1	1. Where pneumatic fall protection guard rails are not fitted on top of a truck, the person working at heights shall ensure the following is complied with: 2. A safety harness must be fitted to trained and competent personnel working on top of the truck 3. A Slow Release Lanyard (SRL) must be used for this type of height work, not an inertia type lanyard. The SRL is to be fixed to an engineered anchor point on top of the truck via a Karabiner certified for the weight of the person. 4. A spotter must be in place at all times while the work on top of the truck is carried out	Supervisor All Workers	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Safety harness fitting	Incorrect fitted harness could cause a malfunction	1	<u>Inspect Harness</u> • Check the straps for fraying, cuts or oil and grease contamination. • Check the buckles for any damage. • Where the harness is damaged DO NOT USE and report situation to your supervisor immediately. <u>Prepare for Fitting</u> • Place the harness on the floor. • The "D" ring should lay flat on the floor. • Lift the leg loops to knee height and reach behind and grasp the "D" ring. • Lift the ring and place arms through the shoulder straps. • Position the "D" ring near the base of the neck. • Grasp the shoulder strap, adjusting tabs in each hand. • Bend at the knees, keeping your back straight. • Pull down on the adjusting straps while in this position until they are firm but not restrictive. • Stand erect. Adjust the weight belt. • DO NOT OVERTIGHTEN. • Secure the chest strap. <u>Remove Harness</u> • Reverse the fitting procedure. <u>Cleaning and Storage</u> • If soiled - wash the harness in a weak detergent solution and allow to dry. • Store in a clean dry area away from any contaminants.	All Workers	2
6 Monthly Inspection	Fall from height	1	1. The complete fall arrest system must be inspected and recorded every 6 months by a competent person. 2. Records are to be maintained for the lesser of 4 years or the life of the various items in the system.	Supervisor	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	Fall from height	1	1. All users of fall protection equipment are to be trained by a competent organisation. 2. Training should include information on the selection of the correct products for intended work situation and pre-use checks for specific equipment. Carrying out rescues and the use of rescue equipment requires technical capability in addition to the ability to use personal fall protection. 3. The requirement for training and the opportunity to maintain competence by either repeat training or rescue practices is essential and should not be underestimated.	Supervisor	2
Care & Maintenance of Safety Harness	Fall from height	1	1. Follow the guidelines set down in the attached SWP- Guidance on the care, maintenance and safe length of service of fall arrest harnesses	All Workers	2
Emergency Rescue	Fall from height	1	1. Call Triple 000 and Follow guidance information from emergency services for rescue of a worker trapped in a safety harness.	Supervisor All Workers	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste asphalt will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management			
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training			

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2018
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.